

Semiconductors (UNIT 1)

Conducter $\rightarrow$ Semiconductor $\rightarrow$ Insulator

$10^4 - 10^7$ $10^{-6} - 10^3$ $10^4 - 10^6$

$$\rho^{-1} = \text{Siemens}$$

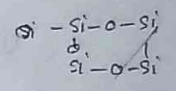
Units σ^{-1}

S cm^{-1}

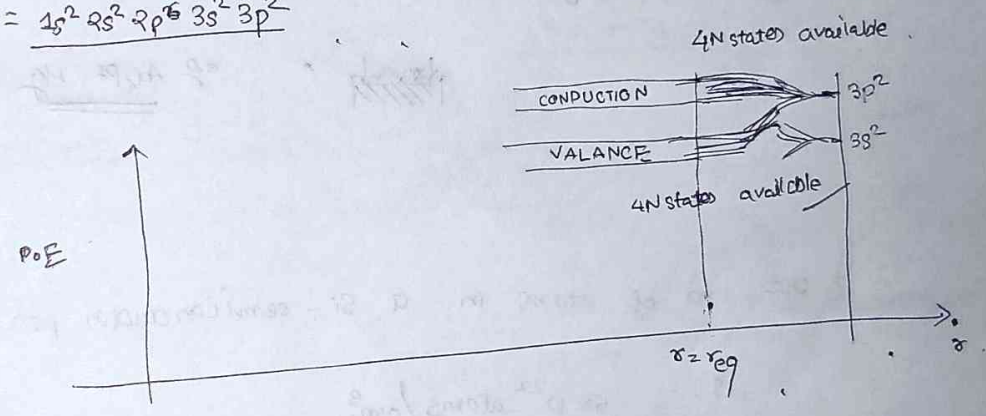
Ω cm^{-1}

mho cm^{-1}

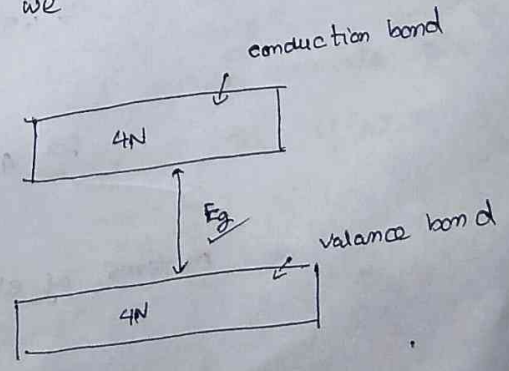
Doping as a regulator in conductivity.



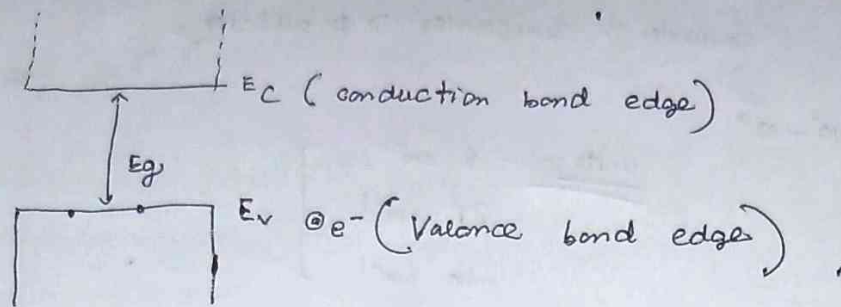
$$s_{14} = \frac{1s^2 2s^2 2p^6 3s^2 3p^2}{4N \text{ states available}}$$



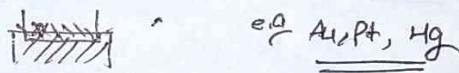
Let's consider N number of atoms are brought to each other, then we obtain the following fig



classification of elements on the basis of energy band gap



- (i) If $E_g < 2\text{eV}$ then it's a semiconductor, e.g. Si, Ge, GaAs etc.
- (ii) If $E_g > 2\text{eV}$, then it's an insulator, quartz, wood.
- (iii) Overlapping bands are found in conductors. [$E_g \approx 0$]



→ The no. of atoms in a Si-semiconductor per unit volume is $5 \times 10^{22} \text{ atoms/cm}^3$.

Let the Si semiconductor is kept at room temperature. The thermal energy $\approx kT$

$$\approx 1.38 \times 10^{-23} \times 300$$

$$\approx 4.2 \times 10^{-21}$$

in terms of eV, $\approx \frac{4.2 \times 10^{-21}}{1.6 \times 10^{-19}} \text{ eV}$

$$\approx \boxed{8.617 \times 10^{-5} \times 300}$$

$$\approx 25.851 \times 10^{-3}$$

$$\begin{array}{r} 8.617 \times 3 \\ \times 300 \\ \hline 25851 \end{array}$$

CONCEPT OF EFFECTIVE MASS

$$\rightarrow E = \frac{\hbar^2 k^2}{2m^*}$$

$\Rightarrow m^*$ is now the eff. mass inside the SM

$$\rightarrow m^* = \frac{\hbar^2}{\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial k^2}}$$

$$m^* \propto \left(\frac{\partial^2 E}{\partial k^2} \right)^{-1}$$

$\rightarrow$ taken into account band structure info on the material

$\rightarrow E-k$ is actually sort of band (structure)

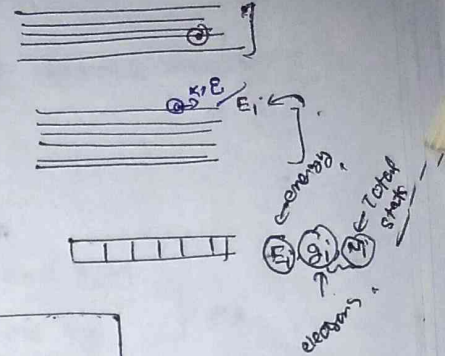
* How momentum changes with energy

$\rightarrow$ All classical physical equations can be applied after taking m^* like

$F = m\dot{v}$

FERMI - DISTRIBUTION

probability = $\frac{N_i}{g_i}$ } → an energy state that can be occupied by one e^- at E_i level

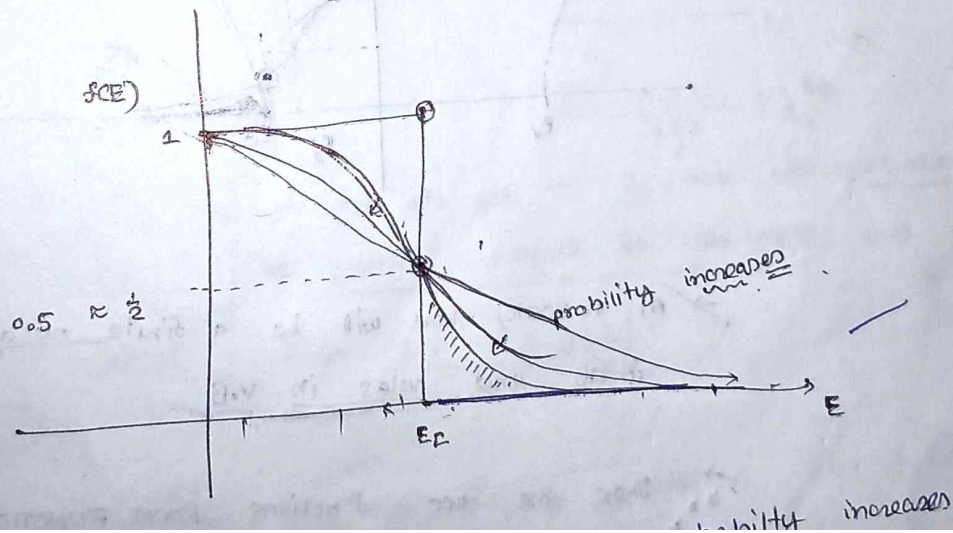


$$f(E_i) = \frac{N_i}{g_i} = \frac{1}{1 + \exp\left[\frac{E_i - E_f}{kT}\right]}$$

give this energy by this fermi function

✓ $E_f = \text{fermi level}$ → it is an statistical const/concept
 → energy level where finding e^- is 50%
 → it is independent of temperature

$$f(E_f) = \frac{1}{2} [50\%]$$



Let's consider the energy of the electron is less than E_F and the considered is OK

$$f(E) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-\infty}} \Rightarrow 1$$

Let's consider the energy of the electron is greater than E_F and the temperature is OK.

$$f(E) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{+\infty}} \Rightarrow 0$$

At $T = 0K$, all the states below Fermi-energy level will be 1 and above the E_{Fermi} will be 0.

electron concentration $n = N_C e^{-\frac{(E_C - E_F)}{KT}}$

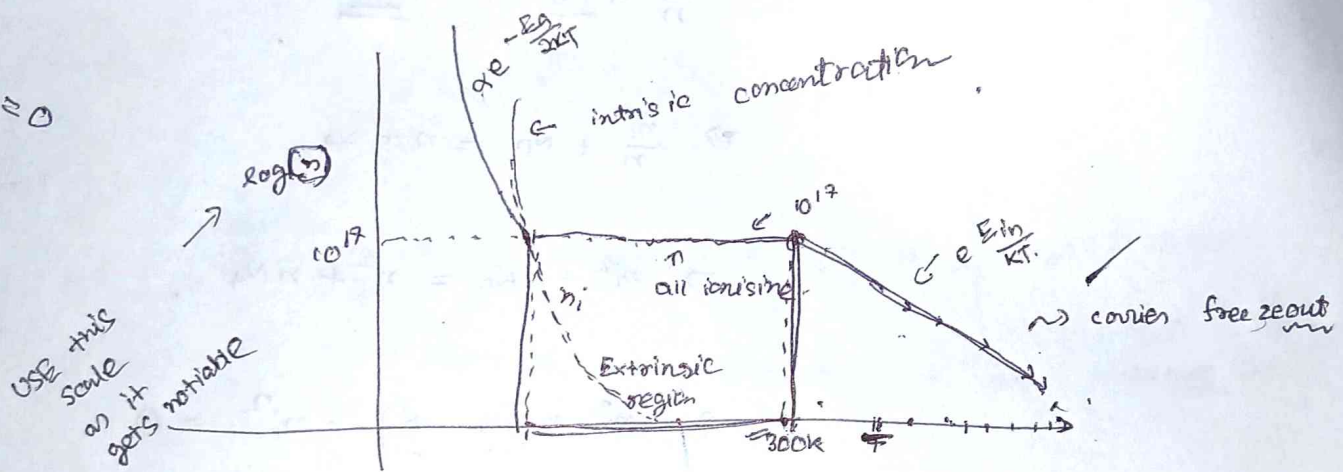
↳ N_C eff. density of state/wells at energy level E_C .

hole concentration $= np = N_V e^{-\frac{(E_F - E_V)}{KT}}$

↳ N_V eff. density of state/wells at energy level E_V .

TEMPERATURE DEPENDENCE

On lowering, not all donors may not get ionised
 $\Rightarrow$ free e⁻s conc reduces as well, and this
 is called carrier freeze-out.



Graph explanation

$\rightarrow$ At low temp, there is very low donor electrons available in ~~the~~ energy-type band, so as you decrease the ~~temp~~ no of e⁻s also gets decreased.

$\rightarrow$ At some temp, all the donors get ionised, and thus the graph remains flat and is the extrinsic region

DENSITY OF STATES

- ① DOS represents the number of available energy states per unit volume per unit energy.

$$g(E) = \int_{E_1}^{E_2} N(E) dE$$

$N(E)$ = density of state energy.

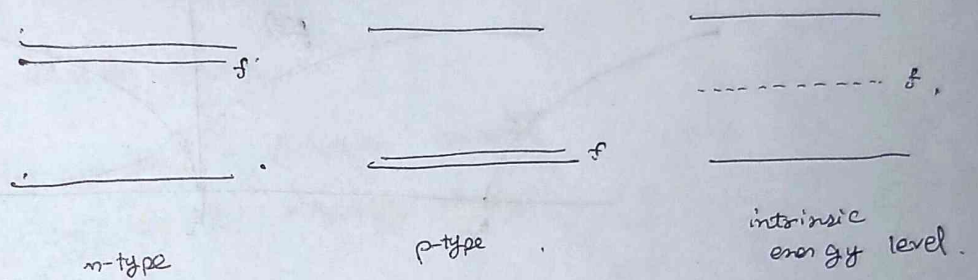
$g(E)$ = no of allowed states per unit of volume

$$g(E) = \frac{4\pi}{h^3} (2m^*)^{3/2} \sqrt{E - E_c} \quad , \text{ vacancy}$$

→ In an n-type semiconductor, the fermi-level lies close to the conduction band.

→ In p-type semiconductor, the fermi level lies near the valance band.

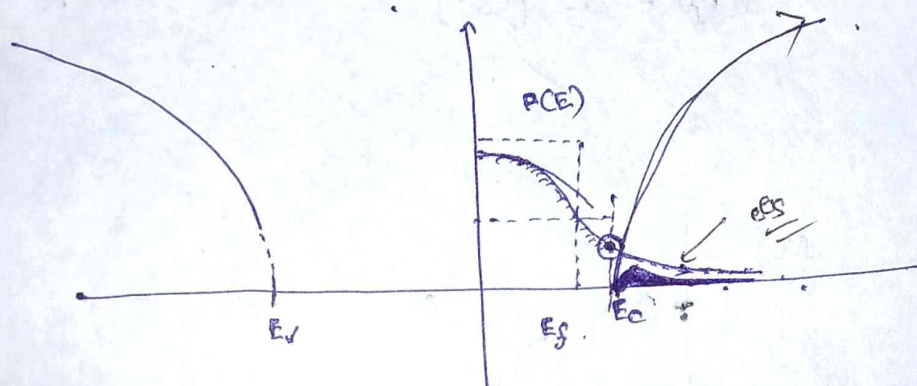
→ In an intrinsic semiconductor, the fermi level lies in the middle of the energy band gap.



Total no of electrons in conduction band

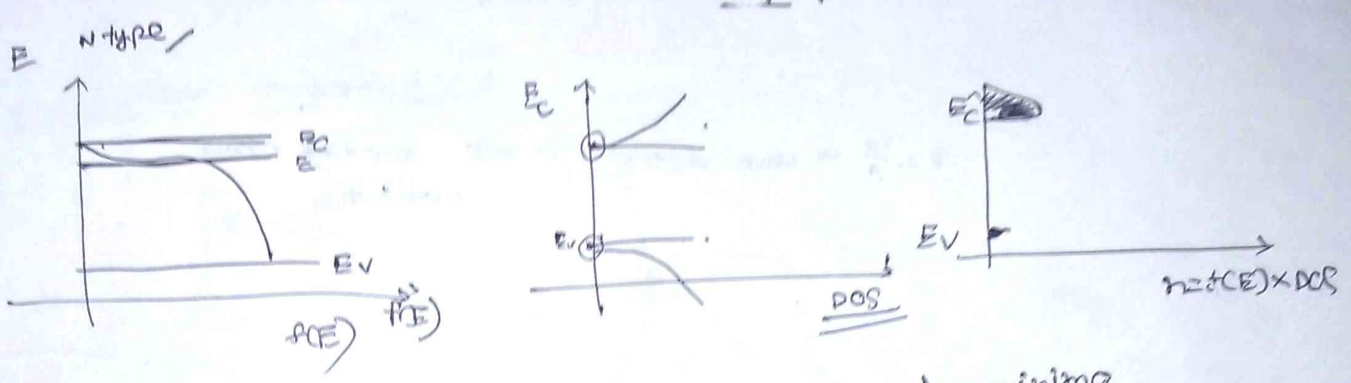
$$n = \int_{E_c}^{\infty} g(E) f(E) dE$$

how many states available $\times$ probability that they occupy



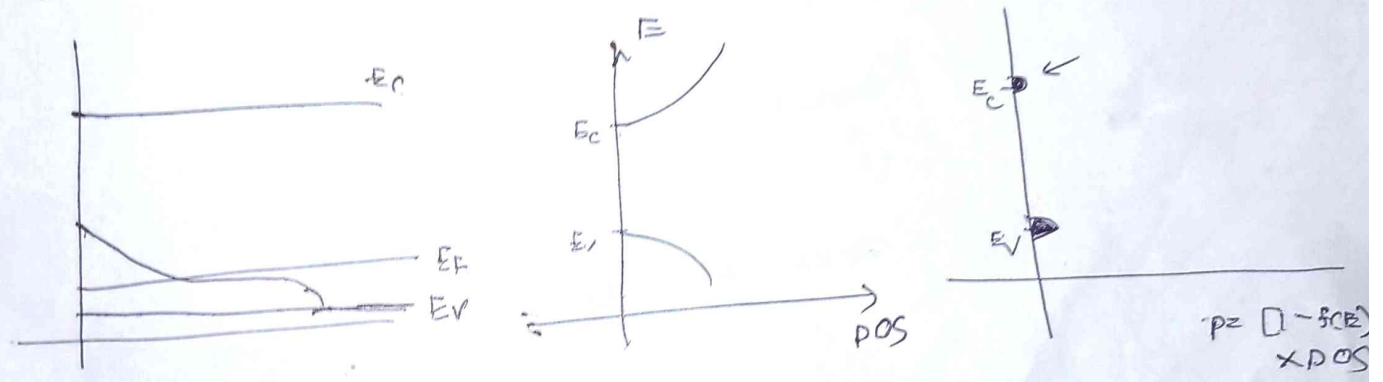
→ At $T = 300K$, there will be a finite no of electrons in CB and holes in V.B

→ Total ^{CARRIER} ~~charge~~ concentration emission



electrons stay at the edge conduction band minima

P-type

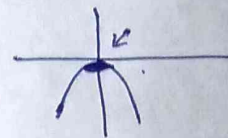
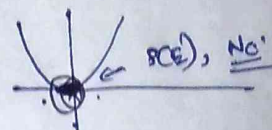


Self explain → (i) N_c is effective conduction band D.O.S (cm^{-3}).
 and it represents the no of rooms at E_c for electrons to live and similar for holes

$$N_c = \left(\frac{2\pi m_e^* kT}{h^2} \right)^{3/2} \times \cancel{\text{D.O.S}}$$

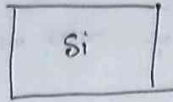
(ii)

$$N_v = \left[\frac{2\pi m_h^* k_B T}{h^2} \right]^{3/2}$$

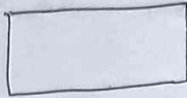


MASS ACTION LAW

→ The product of electron concentration and hole concentration is constant at a given temperature and it is equal to square of intrinsic carrier concentration at that temp.



$$n_i = 1.45 \times 10^{10} / \text{cm}^3$$



→ let the semiconductor is doped with acceptor concentration of $10^{15} / \text{cm}^3$

$$N_A = 10^{15} / \text{cm}^3$$

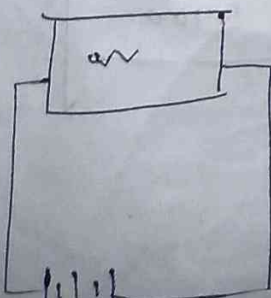
$$n_i = 1.45 \times 10^{10}$$

$$p \times n = [1.45 \times 10^{10}]^2$$

$$n = (1.45)^2 \times 10^5 \text{ cm}^3$$

→ The concentration is decreasing as there is recombination is taking place.

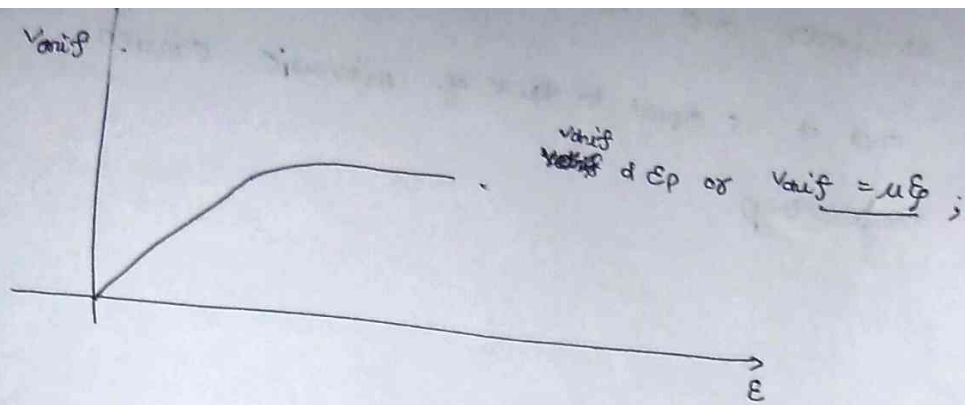
Drift of carriers in a semiconductor,



Let the semiconductor has hole concentration of p and electron concentration of n .

The current density due to hole may be written as :

$$J = q p V_{\text{diff-p}}$$



So, the drift velocity of holes may be written as

$$V_{drift} = \mu_p E$$

So, current density ~~of holes~~ due to may be written as

$$J_p = q p \mu_p E$$

Similarly, the total current density may be written as

$$J = J_p + J_n$$

$$= q p \mu_p E + q n \mu_n E$$

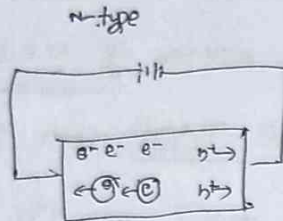
$$J = q (p \mu_p + n \mu_n) E$$

$$J = \sigma E$$

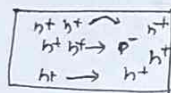
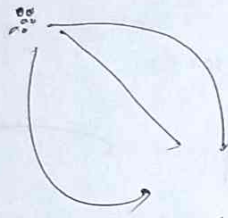
	hole mobility	Electron mobility
Si	450	1350
GeAs	400	8000
Ge	1900	3900

Drift of carriers in a semiconductor

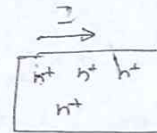
$$J_{\text{drift}} = [qN\mu_n + qp\mu_p]E$$



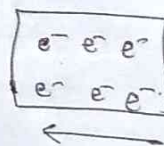
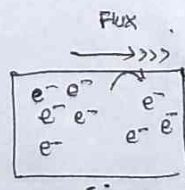
Diffusion of CARRIES IN SEMICONDUCTOR



p-type
→ Non-homogeneous
distribution



homogeneous distribution
of carriers



$$J_{\text{diff}} = qD_n \frac{dn}{dx}$$

$J_{\text{diffusion}}$ = ~~diff~~ diff current due
to electrons

$\frac{dn}{dx}$ = concentration
electron

$D_n =$ diffusion coefficient

$$J_{\text{diffusion}-p} = -q D_p \frac{dp}{dx}$$

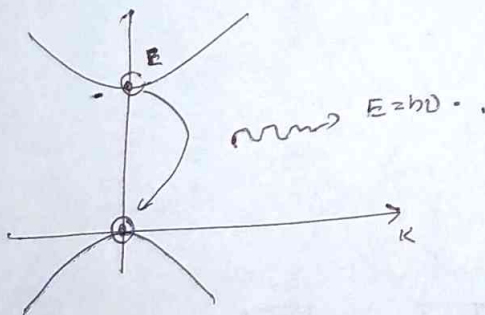
$\frac{dp}{dx} =$ concentration gradient of holes.

$D_p =$ diffusion coeff for holes

Recombination of carriers.

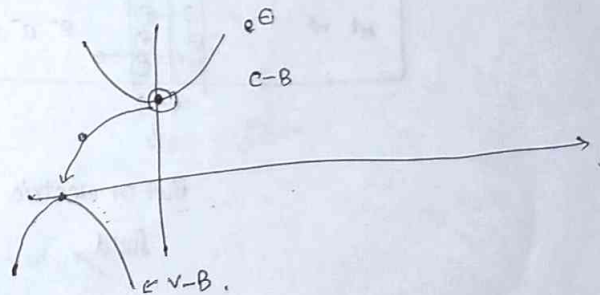
→ Recombination of carriers may take in two processes,

- ① Direct recombination
- ② Indirect recombination.



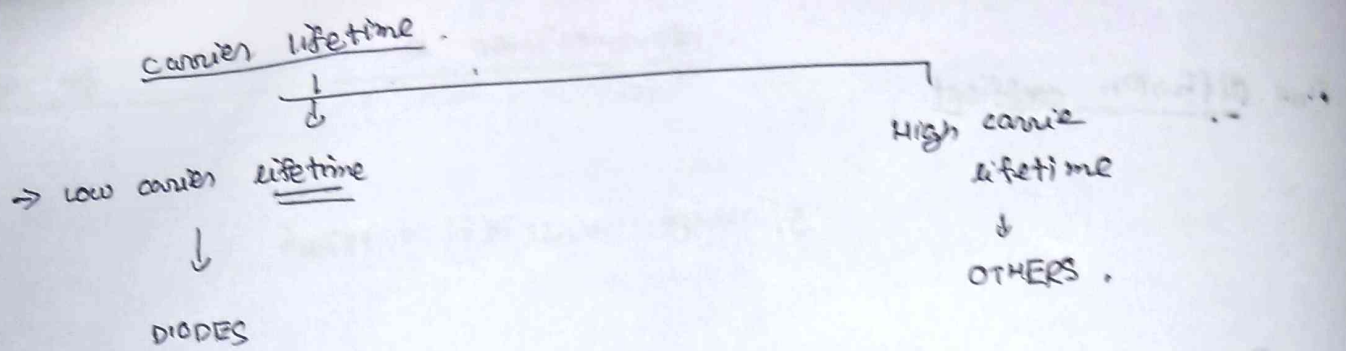
direct band-gap semiconductor.

GaN
GaAs
GaP



↑
some energy is lost
as heat and other
is emitted as
energy

Si
Ge
AlAs



—END OF UNIT 1—